11; Colás and Pozo-Martin 2011; Pozo-Martin 2014).

These disputes, and other instances of friction and conflict such as the war over South Ossetia in August 2008 and the annexation of Crimea in March 2014, are, to put it in terms reminiscent of Lenin, the condensed expression of all the different antagonisms and contradictions which underpin the development of Russian neoliberalism and its complex process of global integration. The first point to make here is that, as can be gleaned from the above discussion, the Russian ruling class is constituted by an amalgam of blurred, interdependent business and bureaucratic interests. The two are, in the words of Tony Wood (quoting the *Financial Times*, and writing on the eve of the global financial crisis), extraordinarily intertwined. There are several noteworthy examples of this beyond Medvedev: there is, for instance, the case of Deputy Prime Minister Igor Sechin, also chairman of Rosneft, the company which engulfed most of the expropriated assets at YUKOS. Sechin is a walking knot of state–capitalist synergies at the highest level: the White House in Washington knows this full well, and has unsurprisingly made an example of him in the sanctions against 'Putin's circle' after the annexation of Crimea.

In the mid-2000s, and taking the presidential administration as a whole, 11 members chaired 6 state companies and had 12 further state directorships; 15 senior government officials held 6 chairmanships and 24 other board seats. Many members of the government are also known to have significant, undisclosed business interests (Wood 2007:60–61). State and business are so closely linked that it is often hard to plot the function, target and character of many policy decisions. In a pervasive legal vacuum, the limits between private ownership and political control not only remain unclear, but must continue to do so. Russian capitalism has thus emerged as a particularly violent, exclusive and authoritarian kind of neoliberal formation.

Further, the outlook of this highly concentrated group has historically appeared as essentially short-termist and mostly ravenous, concentrating more on profit through expansion and less on productive investments in the long term (for instance, see Kagarlitsky 2008:309). The economy's overall reliance on hydrocarbons and the tight symbiotic relation of the Russian state and Russian business (their mutual economic and political reliance) are what makes the Kremlin's foreign policy imperial. It directly calls to mind Harvey's definition of imperialism as a fusion of two distinct logics of power (capitalist and territorial), except that the relation between the two, which Harvey tends to leave under-theorised, appears structural in the Russian case (Harvey 2003:33–34; I return to this point below). In opposition to a pure instrumentalist theory, where individual